NAVEEN TENNAKOON

Senior Software Engineer

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Senior Software Engineer with 5+ years of experience designing and implementing scalable full-stack systems. Strong in feature ownership, technical decision-making, and translating business requirements into maintainable solutions. Proven ability to manage complex feature breakdowns, ensure code quality, and contribute to system architecture while working closely with stakeholders and engineering teams.

TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

Programming languages
JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, Python

Frontend & UI
React.js, HTML5/CSS3, React Native, Flutter

Backend & API
Node.js, Express.js, RESTful API Design

AI/LLM & Observability
OpenAI, Langfuse, Langchain, OpenRouter, Claude code

DevOps, CI/CD & Infrastructure
GitHub Actions/Workflows, Docker

Testing & API tooling
Postman, Cypress

Version control & Collaboration
Git, GitHub

Data & Analytics
BigQuery, Metabase, Posthog

Cloud platforms
GCP, AWS

UI design & Prototyping
Balsamiq, Figma

Databases & Data storage
Firebase, SQL

WORK EXPERIENCE

Avida Life, California

A fitness based tech company that empowers fitness coaches and influencers to provide 1:1 coaching to clients. Technically, we maintain (1) a commission-based full-stack platform enabling coaches to deliver 1:1 fitness coaching, manage clients, and scale their business, (2) a mobile app to support clients on their fitness journey

Senior Software Engineer Jun 2024 - Present

- Led cross-functional product discussions, aligning engineering, product, and business stakeholders.
- Implemented a hosted Instagram agent runner that messages leads on request imitating a human.
- Owned on-call and production operations, including releases, incident response, and critical debugging.
- Designed and implemented an AI-powered workout generation system, integrating it into core workflows to increase coaching productivity.
- Conducted R&D to optimize AI meal plan generation pipelines, reducing inference latency and cost while improving output accuracy and reliability.
- Led an AI hackathon project to automate Instagram message responses for coaches.
- Led technical interviews and mentored software engineer interns, upholding engineering standards and supporting team growth.
- Evaluated and prototyped migration of the mobile application from Ionic to React Native, assessing scalability, performance, and maintainability.
- Architected and delivered a community platform enabling coach-client engagement, driving higher user engagement and retention.
- Built a real-time dashboard to manage coach workloads, reducing operational friction and work overlap.

Software Engineer Jun 2023 - Jun 2024

- Designed and delivered in-house lead capture and post-payment client profiling systems, replacing third-party tools and improving data control.
- Built Metabase dashboards to support transparent analytics and data-driven decisions.
- Improved the GitHub workflow that releases google cloud functions, to avoid deployment failures with scaling, resulting in a complete automated release without any manual work.

Enactor, Hertford

Provider of enterprise-grade Point of Sale (POS) software for major retail customers across the UK and international markets.

Software Engineer May 2022 - Jun 2023

- Worked full-time on the development and enhancement of a large-scale, enterprise POS platform used by renowned retail clients.
- Improved the messaging system purging mechanism, significantly reducing disk usage and improving system reliability.
- Played a key role in delivering a major change request for Frasers Group, implementing loyalty functions and migrating components from Java-based implementations to React, improving frontend flexibility.
- Designed and developed a complete discount workflow for Central Group, including a reusable discount modifier component adopted across the platform.
- Contributed across both backend and frontend layers, demonstrating flexibility to work where project demands required.
- Provided engineering support and technical guidance during customer calls with multiple stakeholders from Central Group, enabling knowledge transfer and supporting in-house development efforts.

SMBApps pty ltd, Australia

Software Development Company providing web and mobile solutions for small to medium-sized businesses.

Junior Developer / Software Engineer Intern Nov 2019 - Apr 2021

- Worked as part of a tightly knit software team delivering web and mobile applications across multiple projects and tech stacks.
- Contributed across the full stack, including frontend, backend, cloud infrastructure, and DevOps-related tasks.
- Designed, built, tested, and deployed RESTful APIs using AWS services.
- Used Docker and Docker Compose for containerization and task automation.
- Implemented real-time features using WebSockets, including streaming and broadcasting from remote camera feeds.
- Prepared UI mockups and wireframes, collaborated with designers and stakeholders.
- Wrote manual test cases, test reports, and implemented test automation scripts.
- Communicated directly with international clients and contributed to R&D initiatives.

PROJECTS

- Deep learning Neural Network model for Sign Language Translation Python, Tensorflow, PyTorch, Keras
  - Researched and improved upon a multi model transformer approach to translate visual cues into text and applied the concept to Sri Lankan sign language
  - Research paper was published to ICTer 2023 international journal

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EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

University of Colombo, School of Computing
BSc. (Hons) in Information Systems Jan 2018 - Apr 2022
GPA: 3.88 (First class)

ESOFT Metro college, Hatton
Diploma in Technology Sep 2016 - Feb 2017
Completed as batch top

References available upon request